



ALESSANDRO FALCO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Battling a Tiny, Disease-Carrying Foe on the Amazon’s Edge

The city of Belém in northern Brazil, hit by dengue in the past, pitches an all-out fight against mosquitoes that enlists its citizens and the insects themselves. Page A7.

Polling’s Wild West Landscape
Makes for Campaign Confusion

Bad Surveys and Betting Odds Before November

By REID J. EPSTEIN

WASHINGTON — When Mandela Barnes dropped out of the Wisconsin governor’s race two weeks before the Democratic primary, he declared, “It has become very clear who our nominee is going to be.”

He meant Francesca Hong, who had a commanding lead in polls — not David Crowley, who ended up narrowly winning the nomination.

Politicians like Mr. Barnes have relied on public and private surveys of voters’ views to guide their decisions for as long as pollsters have sought to measure public opinion. But in this year’s midterm contests, misleading polling has shaped campaign narratives, donor behavior and news coverage like never before.

Polls are traditionally used to measure public opinion, not mold it. But this year, several Democratic campaigns have seized on unreliable polls to push the perception that their candidates are surging to try to solidify support,

attract donors and scare off rivals. The rise of prediction markets has also created financial incentives for untrustworthy or even fake political polls at a moment when it has become even more expensive and difficult to conduct high-quality public opinion surveys.

Some Republicans — particularly President Trump — have for years pointed to dubious polling to advance their political goals, but the phenomenon has become far more acute in Democratic primaries this year. In recent weeks, questionable surveys have created confusion and warped perceptions of the results of key primaries for the party.

In Michigan’s primary for Senate, polls fueled a widespread belief that Representative Haley Stevens, a moderate Democrat, was a major underdog to Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, a progressive. After she voted on Primary Day, the

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In Step With Ally to the North,
Latin America Unifies Its Right

This article is by Emma Bubola, Annie Correal and Ana Ionova.

BUENOS AIRES — Dancing, beating his chest and hugging Flávio Bolsonaro, the right-wing candidate seeking to become Brazil’s next leader, President Javier Milei of Argentina launched into a tirade against Brazil’s current president, calling him a “thief” and “socialist trash.”

Mr. Milei was seeking to aid Mr. Bolsonaro, who is running against President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva in this October’s election, but that brash display of camaraderie in São Paulo came with consequences. After the event last month, Brazil recalled its ambassador to Argentina, generating the most serious rift in decades between South America’s two largest economies.

The episode was only the latest example of the personal alliances and international endorsements

reshaping Latin American politics, as right-wing candidates win elections across the region.

Sharing hard-line policy proposals, campaign mascots and videos of themselves together, they are sending a message of right-wing unity. And, borrowing heavily from President Trump’s playbook, they are openly stepping into neighbors’ elections.

The ascent of right-wing leaders comes as many Latin American voters are frustrated with soaring crime and insecurity, and with what they see as left-wing leaders’ failure to deal with these and other issues, including the economy and immigration.

Like-minded leaders banding together is nothing new on the right or the left, as in the long alliance between Venezuela and Cuba. But this new crop of conservative leaders — many of them political newcomers — is promoting

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Fury Over Data Centers Quickly Shifts Midterms

By SHANE GOLDMACHER

The fight over data centers is suddenly at the epicenter of the midterm elections.

One new ad in Texas begins with someone typing into a chatbot, “Why is my electric bill going up?” Another in Ohio blames one of the state’s Republican senators for a proliferation of data centers, calling them “a total scam.” And in top House battlegrounds in Michigan, Wisconsin and Pennsylvania, the Democratic challengers are all running ads against the server warehouses powering the arti-

Democrats Seize Issue,
and Some in G.O.P.
Join Skepticism

cial intelligence boom.

Data centers have become unlikely fault lines in the broader fight over an A.I. revolution that is remaking the global economy and threatening to disrupt the job market. Now politicians are racing to tap into the backlash — or inoculate themselves — as politi-

cal strategists in both parties described the issue as an unusually fast-moving force that is already reshaping races for the House, the Senate and governors’ mansions.

“It’s very much a bottom-up, organic movement,” said Anna Greenberg, a veteran Democratic pollster, who said that while people’s views on data centers were largely tied to how close they live

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A.I. BUILDING BOOM In a Virginia county, tax revenues have soared, but misgivings are rising. PAGE B1



ALEX KENT/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Sunday Drivers

Racing at the Freedom 250 Grand Prix in downtown Washington, the final major event in the city for the United States’ 250th anniversary. Kyle Kirkwood of the U.S., not shown, took first place.

In Panettiere’s Final Year, Debilitating Pain and Trouble With Ex

By JULIA JACOBS
and MATT STEVENS

This spring, Hayden Panettiere began a book tour at a Barnes & Noble in Manhattan, greeting fans with a bright smile before steeling herself for a discussion about a memoir that chronicles the trials of her life, including struggles with drug and alcohol addiction and an abusive ex-boyfriend.

Before the event in May, the

bookstore was given a specific instruction, according to two people with direct knowledge of the tour: Do not let in a man named Brian Hickerson.

Mr. Hickerson was the former boyfriend Ms. Panettiere had discussed at length in her memoir, which recounted his violence against her that had resulted in three arrests and a stint in jail.

They eventually resumed a tumultuous on-and-off relationship.

Estranged From Family
and Racked by Grief

But by the time of the book tour, she was accompanied by private security with clear instructions to keep him away, according to the two people.

“I needed an incredible amount of support and backup in order to

make sure that there was no way for him to find his way back in,” Ms. Panettiere said on a podcast in May.

Three months later, Mr. Hickerson was present when she was pronounced dead in an apartment complex in Greenville, S.C. The police have said there were no signs of foul play, and neither Mr. Hickerson nor his brother Zach, who are listed in a police report as

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Tests for World’s Breadbaskets

Wars, bad weather, low harvests and trade disputes are threatening to drive the price of wheat higher. PAGE A4

Zelensky Chides Ex-Minister

The Ukrainian president said his former defense minister was wrong to call for elections amid the war. PAGE A8

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He Wants to Live to 150. Why?

Bryan Johnson, a wealthy tech entrepreneur and longevity guru, said he was the world’s healthiest man. Then came a stunning diagnosis. PAGE A9

Trial of Mother Divides Nation

The Clancy case has kindled debates over whether such women are criminals or victims. News Analysis. PAGE A16

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An Influential Rock Critic

Dave Marsh, a veteran of Cream and Rolling Stone, shaped how the world saw the genre. He was 76. PAGE B5



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South Bronx Park Decays

The old Yankee Stadium site was meant to honor history. Now it’s a symbol of neglect to the area’s residents. PAGE D1

Coventry City’s Journey

The club was exiled from its own stadium and relegated to the fourth tier before its Premier League return. PAGE D6

BUSINESS B1-4

Economy Could Feel the Sting

A tit-for-tat trade fight between Canada and the United States could create new headaches for American consumers and businesses already struggling to keep up with high prices. PAGE B1

‘Dying Community’ in Alaska

Diesel generators produce the electricity for small towns, with much of the fuel coming from crude refined in other parts of the world. Prices are soaring with no end in sight. PAGE B1

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Adam Jentleson

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Beyond the Manosphere

Richard Gadd, the creator and star of “Half Man,” had no particular agenda for the dark tale of male repression. But some people thought otherwise. PAGE C1



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